Name: Redenelle Maurice L. Manangu
Section: CS-403
Date: 06-29-2026
Subject: 2212-4RIZAL

Assessment 1: Reflective Essay

For me, José Rizal's journey to becoming a hero was not a mere coincidence. His intentional transformation, shaped by various factors such as family, social injustices, educational experiences, and strong moral values, transformed a boy from Calamba into the intellectual heart of a nation. Understanding what led to José Rizal's transformation would serve as useful insight for personal development as well as education that produces socially responsible professionals. Through Rizal's early life in Calamba, he has been brought up by family devotion, education, and cultural and environmental exposure to become an open-minded, disciplined, and compassionate individual. The qualities became the basis for Rizal's future achievements as a writer, reformist, and national hero. Teodora Alonso, Rizal's mother and his first teacher, is the core of these qualities. She taught Rizal to read, appreciate stories, and love literature, which nurtured his natural curiosity and sense of justice (Dalisay, 2026). It is a good point to consider that mentoring begins in our houses and what we do in public places will have consequences in our lives.

Formal education and political engagement played a significant role in shaping Rizal's character beyond his family background. The need for justice and changes motivated him because of the influence of interaction with his brother Paciano, the unjust sacrifice of the Gomburza priests, and Jesuit education, which was morally responsible and highly critical. His mother's injustice only made his character even more dedicated (Dalisay, 2026). The intellectual horizon of Rizal greatly broadened as he finally managed to study in Europe. Along with his contribution to La Solidaridad, he wrote two political novels, Noli Me Tangere and El Filibusterismo, having a huge impact on the Philippine nation. Together with López Jaena and Marcelo del Pilar, he became one of the key leaders of the Propaganda Movement (Britannica Editors, 2020). Instead of resorting to violence to show his anger, Rizal decided to turn it into writing, making his pen the most powerful weapon. This choice exemplified his heritage. Rather than resorting to violence to express his love for the Philippines, he utilised his knowledge, skills, and abilities to enlighten his fellow countrymen through peaceful means, including novels, essays, and articles (Grin, McFly International, Christopher F. Bueno, 2012).

Reflecting on Rizal's experiences brings to light a significant truth about my own personal growth. In this case, I have realised that moving away from self-centredness is of great importance in terms of real development. Just like Rizal, I have realised that there is a need for me to open myself up and be aware of the fact that the education and skills I possess do not belong only to me, but instead, they are also a responsibility I owe to the community I serve. The path taken by Rizal shows me that the consistency between professional and moral qualities should always be a conscious effort.

Name: Redenelle Maurice L. Manangu
Section: CS-403

Date: 06-29-2026
Subject: 2212-4RIZAL

References:

Grin Mcfly International Christopher F. Bueno. (2012). Jose P. Rizal: The National Hero. *ResearchGate*. https://www.researchgate.net/publication/260189936_Jose_P_Rizal_The_National_Hero

Britannica Editors. (2020, July 15). *Propaganda Movement | Facts, Definition, & History*. Encyclopedia Britannica. https://www.britannica.com/topic/Propaganda-Movement

Dalisay, S. (2026, May 8). Rizal's Childhood and Early Education: From Calamba to Manila. *Jose Rizal*. https://www.joserizal.com/life/rizal-early-life/